

VISHAL GONDAL
Founder & Chairman,
nCore Games

INDIA'S NEXT GLOBAL EXPORT

**GAMING, NOT GAMBLING, IS INDIA'S TRUE
CREATIVE OPPORTUNITY**

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From the days when games arrived in India via floppy disks and pirated CDs, to the era of feature phones, and finally to today's always-online, mobile-first gaming economy, Gondal has not just watched the industry grow – he has repeatedly helped shape it.

Often described as *India's first crorepati gamer*, Gondal earned that reputation not from esports winnings, but by turning gaming itself into a serious business at a time when very few in India believed it could be one. As the founder and chairman of nCore Games, he has focused on building games that are unapologetically Indian in theme and ambition, proving that local stories and mass-market reach can coexist. Over the years, his work has spanned game development and advocacy.

That advocacy role has seen Gondal become a founding member of the Indian Game Publishers and Developers Association (IGPDVishal; an industry body created to give India's fragmented gaming ecosystem a unified voice, as he explains:

You have seen Indian gaming from the 1990s to today. What has really changed, and why are the next few years so important?

Vishal: What changed is access and belief. In the 1990s, gaming in India was expensive and limited to a few people with PCs or consoles. Distribution was messy and scale was impossible. Everything changed with cheap mobile internet. Suddenly, anyone with a phone could play. Games became free to start, and millions joined in. Today, India has nearly 500 million gamers.

The bigger change is on the creator side. We now have developers who grew up playing games. They understand stories, emotions, and what players want. The next 2–5 years matter because money, talent, and government support are finally